

■ Russia Geopolitical News Report

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Date Coverage: 2026-05-15 to 2026-05-15

1. Pashinyan's rivals have not gotten any closer to overcoming the opposition's fragmentation in a month.

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Caucasian Knot

■ **URL:** <https://www.eng.kavkaz-uzel.eu/articles/75261>

■ **Summary:**

The fragmentation of the opposition has not diminished over the past month amid the onset of the campaign and increased pressure, with the main opposition parties vying for votes and political leadership. Representatives of the Strong Armenia party and the Armenia bloc pointed to the importance of the country's partnership with Russia, but emphasized the importance of an independent policy. As reported by the Caucasian Knot, the Central Election Commission of Armenia registered all 19 political forces that applied to participate in the parliamentary elections. On May 14, the Central Election Commission annulled the registrations of 45 candidates for parliamentary seats in Armenia who had filed self-withdrawal notices, including candidates on the Wings of Unity and Bright Armenia lists. The election campaign in Armenia, which began on May 8, is in full swing. While in the first days of the election campaign, political forces focused primarily on their respective platforms, in the last few days, the debate between team leaders has become more emotional, not without insults and scandalous statements, reports a "Caucasian Knot" correspondent. Strong Armenia party leader Samvel Karapetyan is still under house arrest and cannot personally participate in the campaign. This is being handled by his nephew, Narek Karapetyan, who is number one on the party's list and, therefore, currently the only prime ministerial candidate. Samvel Karapetyan recently announced that he has begun the pr

2. Patriotic protest or hate march? What is 'Unite the Kingdom'? -- RT World News

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** RT

■ **URL:** <https://www.rt.com/news/640031-tommy-robinson-unite-the-kingdom/>

■ **Summary:**

Tommy Robinson's 'Unite the Kingdom' rally is so controversial that the British government has deployed the latest surveillance technology against attendees and banned speakers from entering the country. What are they so scared of? Tens of thousands of protesters are expected at the Unite the Kingdom rally in London on Saturday, where they will march through the streets of the British capital to government buildings at Whitehall. The rally is expected to be the largest right-wing gathering in the UK this year, as public anger against Prime Minister Keir Starmer builds on both sides of the political spectrum. The first Unite the Kingdom rally took place in July 2024. Riding a wave of right-wing anger - amplified by the stabbing of three children by a teenager of Rwandan descent two days later - organizer Tommy Robinson held further events that October, and in September 2025. Last year's rally took place after a wave of protests and riots at hotels housing asylum seekers, and included speeches from French Reconquete (Reconquest) leader Eric Zemmour, Polish Law and Justice MEP Dominik Tarczynski, and Elon Musk, who addressed demonstrators via video link. Described by the media as "anti-Islam," "far-right," and "xenophobic," the rally drew attendees frustrated with rising immigration, the growing influence of Islam in British politics, and Starmer's response to earlier protests and riots - which involved jailing hundreds of people for online speech and advancing a draconian onlin

3. Romania to sign UAV joint production agreement with Ukraine in 1-3 months

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/world/2131573>

■ **Summary:**

Notably, in March, Dan and Vladimir Zelensky signed a strategic partnership agreement in Bucharest BUCHAREST, May 15. /TASS/. Romanian President Nicusor Dan has announced that Bucharest will sign an agreement with Kiev on the joint production of unmanned aerial vehicles (UAVs) within the next one to three months. The announcement was made during his visit to the Black Sea Defense and Aerospace (BSDA-2026) international aviation and defense industry exhibition in Bucharest. A transcript of his conversation with journalists is available on the presidential administration's website. When asked about the timing of the agreement, Dan provided a twofold response. He explained that the first component involves incorporating UAV production into Romania through the EU's military lending program, SAFE. This component is expected to be financed via SAFE and is slated for signing by May 31. The second aspect pertains to a broader cooperation framework with Ukraine on drone technology, including counter-UAV systems. Dan indicated that discussions on this front have only recently begun and that a technical process is currently underway, which he expects to conclude within one to three months. Notably, in March, Dan and Vladimir Zelensky signed a strategic partnership agreement in Bucharest. This pact encompasses various areas of cooperation, including joint defense material production and energy collaboration. One of the documents formalized during this visit specifically addresses the joi

4. Roscongress Foundation publishes business program for SME Forum at SPIEF

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/economy/2131575>

■ **Summary:**

The Forum's business programme will be divided into five thematic blocks: "SMEs and the State", "Accelerating SMEs", "Industries and Digitalization", "Workforce" and "Foreign Economic Activities" MOSCOW, May 15. /TASS/. On June 3, the opening day of the St. Petersburg International Economic Forum (SPIEF), the 11th Russian Forum of Small and Medium-Sized Enterprises will take place, with "Creative Code of Economy: A New Growth Formula for SMEs" being this year's central

theme, the Roscongress Foundation announced. "Small and medium-sized business remains one of the key drivers of sustainable economic development and increased business activity in the regions of Russia. Today it is important to ensure conditions for the further growth of the SME sector, to expand opportunities for entrepreneurs, to introduce modern technological and managerial solutions, and to develop new areas, including the creative industries. The Russian SME Forum at the SPIEF venue traditionally brings together representatives of government, business and development institutions to discuss practical mechanisms for supporting entrepreneurship and to work out solutions aimed at achieving the country's national development goals," said Russian Deputy Prime Minister Alexander Novak. The Forum's business programme will be divided into five thematic blocks: "SMEs and the State", "Accelerating SMEs", "Industries and Digitalization", "Workforce" and "Foreign Economic Activities". The key event of the day will be

5. Ukrainian draft officers filmed forcibly detaining recruits (VIDEOS) -- RT Russia & Former Soviet Union

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** RT

■ **URL:** <https://www.rt.com/russia/640035-ukraine-draft-odessa-kiev/>

■ **Summary:**

Compulsory military service continues to fuel frustration and anger across the country. New videos circulating online show Ukrainian military recruiters and police officers forcibly detaining men and placing them into unmarked vehicles for possible mobilization into the conflict with Russia. Ukraine continues to rely on mandatory conscription to replenish troop numbers at the front line, with press gangs operating in major cities and rural areas alike. The mobilization campaign has increasingly sparked public resentment, with many Ukrainians accusing officials of corruption and abuse of power. Videos showing confrontations between civilians and draft officers regularly spread across social media platforms. In one recent clip from the Black Sea city of Odessa, a man is seen clinging to the legs of military recruiters as they drag him into a van. The footage was reportedly submitted to a local Telegram news channel by the man himself, who claimed he was legally exempt from military service. Another video from Kiev shows police officers forcing a young man into a vehicle while bystanders shout at the officials. The man resists so strongly that the officers drive away with the rear door still open and his legs hanging outside the car. The practice of forced mobilization has

become widely known in Ukraine as 'busification', a reference to the vans used to transport detained men to conscription centers. Officials acknowledge that the campaign has become one of the biggest sources of

6. BRICS foreign ministers reach mutual understanding on almost all agenda items -- Indian MFA

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/world/2131567>

■ Summary:

According to Sudhakar Dalela, the BRICS foreign ministers expressed firm support for practical cooperation in various areas NEW DELHI, May 15. /TASS/. Participants in the BRICS Foreign Ministers' Meeting held in the Indian capital reached mutual understanding on almost all items of the agenda, Indian Deputy Foreign Minister Sudhakar Dalela, whose country holds the group's chairmanship, stated at a press conference. "On almost all issues discussed within the framework of the three key areas of our strategic partnership - politics and security, economy and finance, as well as culture and people-to-people contacts - we managed to find common ground and reach a mutual understanding among all participants," he said. Dalela emphasized that the final document reflects the unified position of the member states on practically all topics considered. According to Dalela, the BRICS foreign ministers expressed firm support for practical cooperation in various areas. "In the future, we will continue to interact with all BRICS members and partner countries, striving to reach consensus wherever possible," he added. Answering a question about the discussion of events in the Middle East, the representative of the Indian foreign policy department acknowledged that "there were some differences in views among some members of the association regarding the situation in the Middle East." "The BRICS countries presented their national positions and shared a wide range of views on this issue. Among the

7. First issue of Islamic sukuk bonds in Russia announced in Kazan

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/economy/2131571>

■ **Summary:**

The deal will result in the construction of a production complex at an industrial park in Tatarstan KAZAN, May 15. /TASS/. The first issue of Islamic sukuk bonds in Russia was announced at the 17th International Economic Forum "Russia - Islamic World: KazanForum," the forum's organizers reported. "VEB.RF and Alabuga Development LLC, pursuant to the agreement on cooperation and collaboration in developing partnership financing between the government of the Republic of Tatarstan and VEB.RF dated May 16, 2025, signed a loan agreement under partnership financing terms for an amount exceeding 3.5 billion rubles (\$47.9 mln) with a repayment term of two years. The transaction is being implemented under a limited mudarabah format," the forum's organizers said in a statement. The transaction will result in the construction of a production complex at the Northern Gate Industrial Park in Tatarstan. Funds for the project will be raised by the end of the second quarter of 2026 through the placement of VEB.RF's debut partnership financing bond issue. According to VEB.RF Deputy Chairman Konstantin Vyshkovsky, the bond issue was organized by Gazprombank (as the coordinating bank) and Sberbank. "We are interested in expanding our range of debt instruments, allowing us to attract new categories of investors willing to participate in project implementation with us in Russia, sharing both the risks and the economic results. We expect that, in the long term, such instruments will attract investor

8. Trump to consult with Taiwan before deciding whether to continue selling arms to island

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/world/2131565>

■ **Summary:**

The US president warned that the US policy toward Taiwan risks provoking a confrontation between Washington and Beijing WASHINGTON, May 15. /TASS/. US President Donald Trump intends to

quickly decide, following consultations with Taiwanese administration head Lai Ching-te, whether Washington will continue supplying arms to the island. "I'm going to make a determination," the US leader said, commenting on the possibility of further arms and military equipment deliveries to Taiwan during a conversation with reporters aboard his plane en route from Beijing to Anchorage and on to Washington. "I have to speak to the person that right now is - you know who he is - running Taiwan," Trump pointed out. The US president effectively disagreed with his Chinese counterpart Xi Jinping, who warned that the US policy toward Taiwan risks provoking a confrontation between Washington and Beijing. "I think we will be fine," the US leader stressed. "He (Xi Jinping - TASS) does not want to see a fight for independence because that would be a very strong confrontation," Trump noted. "I heard him out. I didn't make a comment on it. I have a lot of respect for him," the US leader added. Xi Jinping warned Trump that the wrong approach to resolving the Taiwan issue could provoke a direct confrontation between Beijing and Washington. He called the Taiwan issue the most important one in China-US relations. The pursuit of "island independence" and peace in the region are mutually exclusive, the Chinese le

9. Stars, stripes, and missiles: What America's arsenal says about the wars to come -- RT World News

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** RT

■ **URL:** <https://www.rt.com/news/639991-stars-stripes-and-missiles/>

■ **Summary:**

From Minuteman silos to hypersonic missiles, the Pentagon is preparing for a new era of confrontation. The US boasts impressive military capabilities that solidify the country's position among the world's military powers. This also applies to missile technology - the US maintains its status as a major global missile power, and long competed with the Soviet Union in the missile and space race. The US did not immediately recognize the potential for developing powerful rockets for launching spacecraft and delivering nuclear warheads over intercontinental distances. However, it soon caught up with the USSR and leveraged its advantages effectively. By investing significant resources and attracting top engineering talent, the US achieved breakthroughs in several areas: Solid rocket fuels, simple silo-based launch systems, compact thermonuclear warheads, and advanced guidance systems enhanced by cutting-edge electronics. These advancements ultimately

led to the development of Multiple Independently Targetable Reentry Vehicles (MIRVs) and cruise missiles. The Cold War rivalry with the Soviet Union played a crucial role in the evolution of US missile technology, particularly in the development of the nuclear triad. The US strategic nuclear forces were initially composed of a substantial fleet of long-range bombers designed to carry atomic bombs. Though the US was engaged in developing rocket technology, at the time, it did not receive the same level of priority as it did in the Soviet

10. Trump's China trip an attempt to 'save face' - analyst to RT -- RT World News

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** RT

■ **URL:** <https://www.rt.com/news/640016-us-china-visit-save-face/>

■ **Summary:**

The US delegation came hoping Beijing would offer deals easing tensions caused by Washington's foreign policy blunders, such as Iran war, Danny Haiphong says US President Donald Trump's China visit was an attempt to "save face" and seek relief after the Iran war destabilized the global economy, geopolitical analyst Danny Haiphong has told RT. According to Haiphong, the US is now in a "far weaker position" than China and is seeking closer ties with Beijing to stabilize its economy and global standing. US-China relations have been strained for years over trade, technology, and security, with Trump's tariff hikes last year escalating tensions into a full-scale trade war before both sides agreed to a temporary pause. Expectations for a breakthrough were high ahead of Trump's May 13-15 China visit - his first in nearly a decade - but no major deals or clear breakthroughs were officially announced before the trip ended Friday. In an interview on Thursday, Haiphong argued that the US delegation came to China "hoping to essentially get saved from the crisis of their own making" in Iran and its global fallout. US-Israeli strikes on Iran triggered retaliation against countries hosting US bases and led to the de facto closure of the Strait of Hormuz - a route for roughly 20% of global oil and LNG supplies - sending energy prices soaring. "The US was the one who requested this meeting, and it's the US economy as a whole and the global economy that is suffering because of [its] aggressive

11. India and UAE ink energy and defense pacts -- RT India

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** RT

■ **URL:** <https://www.rt.com/india/640023-india-and-uae-ink-energy/>

■ **Summary:**

India and the United Arab Emirates have inked energy and defense pacts during Prime Minister Narendra Modi's trip to the Gulf nation on Friday. Modi started his five-nation tour with a brief visit to the UAE, after which he will head to the Netherlands, Sweden, Norway, and Italy. The UAE also pledged investments in India worth \$5 billion, including the investment of \$4 billion by Emirati financial entities in Indian banks and \$1 billion pledge by the Abu Dhabi Investment Authority (ADIA) with the National Infrastructure & Investment Fund of India (NIIF) in priority infrastructure projects in India. Pacts on a defense partnership framework, strategic petroleum reserves, and an agreement for the supply of liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) were also signed, according to the statement by Modi's office. The energy pact includes potential collaboration in liquefied natural gas and liquefied petroleum gas storage facilities in India. A memorandum of understanding to build a ship repair cluster at Vadinar in the western state of Gujarat was also signed. An understanding has also been reached to establish a supercomputer cluster. During the meeting with UAE President Sheikh Mohammed bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Modi also condemned the attacks on the UAE amid the Middle East conflict. "We strongly condemn the attacks on the UAE and denounce the way the UAE has been targeted. This is unacceptable in any form," he said. "India has always vouched for dialogue and diplomacy," he said, adding, "our pri

12. CSTO improving, adapting its mechanisms to new realities -- secretary general

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/world/2131547>

■ Summary:

According to Taalatbek Masadykov, the CSTO has come a long way from a political agreement to a multifaceted organization with powerful military-political potential MOSCOW, May 15. /TASS/. The Collective Security Treaty Organization (CSTO) is continuously improving and adapting its mechanisms to new realities, CSTO Secretary General Taalatbek Masadykov stressed in an address on the occasion of the 34th anniversary of the signing of the Collective Security Treaty. "The decision made in Tashkent more than 30 years ago was fateful for the Eurasian space. The foundation laid then allowed us to build an effective collective security system. The organization is continuously improving, adapting its mechanisms to new realities, but fidelity to the spirit of the 1992 Treaty and the principles of equality remains the unwavering guarantee of our peaceful future," he noted. "On this day, we pay tribute to the political wisdom of the leaders who laid the foundations of the CSTO, who, through the turbulence of the times, were able to discern the unwavering value of alliance," Masadykov stressed. "The solidarity forged over time, based on shared history and strategic partnership, continues to serve as a reliable shield against any attempts at destabilization." According to the secretary general, the CSTO has come a long way from a political agreement to a multifaceted organization with powerful military-political potential. "Coordinating foreign policy steps and jointly countering terrorism,

13. Saraliev reported on the prisoner exchange with Ukraine.

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Caucasian Knot

■ **URL:** <https://www.eng.kavkaz-uzel.eu/articles/75260>

■ Summary:

The first stage of a major prisoner exchange took place today with Ukraine. Chechen State Duma Deputy Shamsail Saraliev reported that 205 prisoners of war returned to Russia. As reported by the "Caucasian Knot," on March 5 and 6, Russia and Ukraine conducted a 500-for-500 prisoner of war exchange. A month earlier, on February 5, 157 military personnel and three civilians were returned to Russia during the first prisoner exchange of 2026. On April 24, Chechen State Duma Deputy Shamsail Saraliev announced another prisoner of war exchange between Russia and Ukraine, specially thanking Ramzan Kadyrov. He indicated that the Ukrainian participants in the exchange were captured by Akhmat fighters. Shamsail Saraliev, a State Duma deputy from Chechnya and a

representative of the parliamentary coordination group on military affairs, reported on the latest prisoner exchange between Russia and Ukraine. During today's exchange, 205 servicemen from various regions returned to Russia from Ukrainian captivity, and 205 Ukrainian prisoners were returned to Ukraine, Shamsail Saraliev reported on his Telegram channel. The Russian soldiers are currently in Belarus, where they are receiving the necessary psychological and medical care. They will subsequently be transported to Russia for treatment and rehabilitation. The United Arab Emirates acted as an intermediary in the exchange, the press service reported. Russian Ministry of Defense.

14. IN BRIEF: Putin's statements on results of government's economic measures, SPIEF program

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/economy/2131559>

■ **Summary:**

The Russian president said the measures taken by the government to improve the economic situation are already yielding positive results MOSCOW, May 15. /TASS/. The measures taken by the Russian government to improve the economic situation are already yielding positive results, President Vladimir Putin said at a meeting on economic issues. He also announced that the business program of the St. Petersburg International Economic Forum (SPIEF) will traditionally be extensive. TASS has compiled the head of state's key statements. Measures taken by the government to improve the economic situation are already yielding positive results: "I would like to point out right away that the measures and decisions implemented recently by the Russian government have begun to yield a certain - let's say it cautiously but still - a certain positive result." Economic statistics for March are positive: "This is indicated by positive statistics for March of this year." It is necessary to consolidate the positive dynamics in the Russian economy so that growth becomes more sustainable: "I'm asking the government to continue to prioritize supporting economic growth. We need to ensure that the positive momentum that has emerged is consolidated and expands to more industries and sectors, thereby making economic growth more robust and sustainable." The unemployment rate in Russia "remains at a minimum level of 2.2%." "Overall, the country's GDP grew by 1.8% in March." "Consumer activity accelerated in Ma

15. Russia's international reserves up \$13.5 bln in one week to \$771 bln -- Central Bank

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/economy/2131561>

■ **Summary:**

Russia's international reserves up \$13.5 bln in one week to \$771 bln -- Central Bank MOSCOW, May 15. /TASS/. Russia's international reserves increased by \$13.5 bln in one week to \$771 bln as of May 8, 2026, the Central Bank reported. "International reserves amounted to \$771 bln as of the end of the day on May 8, 2026, having increased by \$13.5 bln, or by 1.8%, in one week mainly due to positive revaluation," the regulator said. As of May 1, the country's reserves totaled \$757.5 bln. Russia's international reserves reached a record high of \$826.8 bln on January 30. Russia's international reserves are highly liquid foreign assets available with the Bank of Russia and the Russian government. They comprise foreign currency, Special Drawing Rights (SDRs), a reserve position in the International Monetary Fund and monetary gold. Following the onset of Moscow's special military operation in Ukraine Western countries slapped sanctions against the Bank of Russia. Apart from freezing Russia's gold and foreign currency reserves, all transactions related to management of the regulator's reserves and assets, as well as transactions with any legal entity, organization or body acting on behalf or at the direction of the Central Bank, were prohibited.

16. Fantastic trade deals, very successful visit: Trump's trip to China in review

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/world/2131535>

■ Summary:

BEIJING, May 15. /TASS/. US President Donald Trump described his visit to China as "very successful" and stated that the two sides had managed to resolve many issues. China's Foreign Ministry, in turn, noted that the interaction between Chinese leader Xi Jinping and Trump during the White House chief's current visit to Beijing contributed to deepening Sino-American cooperation and global stability. TASS has compiled the key points about the results of Trump's visit to China. - Trump expressed the utmost respect for Xi Jinping and described his relationship with the Chinese leader as "a very strong one." - After meeting with the Chinese president, the US leader described Xi as all business, not one to play games. - Trump once again expressed hope that Xi Jinping would visit the United States this September. - The leaders' talks were candid, said US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer. - Xi noted that Trump's visit to China was a "historic and landmark event." - According to him, this once again proves that the peaceful coexistence of the two nations, their mutually beneficial cooperation based on respect, and the search for "a right path to get along with each other" align with the will of the people of both countries and the expectations of the entire world. - He said that both nations should properly implement the consensus reached between the leaders of China and the United States, cherish the current favorable trend, which was not easily achieved, chart the right course, r

17. It will take Iran a whole generation to restore its navy to pre-war level -- CENTCOM chief

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/world/2131531>

■ Summary:

According to Admiral Brad Cooper, the US achieved its goals during Operation Epic Fury and was able to reduce Iran's defense industrial base by 90% WASHINGTON, May 15. /TASS/. It will take a generation for the Iranian navy to go back to what it was before the war with the US and Israel, US Central Command (CENTCOM) chief Admiral Brad Cooper said. "My professional perspective on this also is that Iran would not return to the same level of navy that it had for a generation," the CENTCOM chief told the Senate armed services committee on Thursday. According to Cooper, the US achieved its goals during Operation Epic Fury and was able to reduce Iran's defense industrial

base by 90%. "The defense industrial base for their drones and their missiles and their navy were degraded by 90 percent. They have about 10 percent left for the navy," he said. Admiral Cooper believes that the Iranian navy will only begin to recover in five to 10 years, as it is a complex process, made more difficult when there is no industrial base for its construction. The United States and Israel launched the war against Iran on February 28. On April 7, the White House announced a two-week mutual ceasefire. According to Tehran, 3,375 Iranians have been killed in US-Israeli strikes during the 40 days of the hostilities. On April 11, Tehran and Washington held talks in Islamabad, but the parties failed to reach an agreement on a long-term settlement to the conflict due to a number of disagreements. On April 21, th

18. Meeting on economic issues

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** President of Russia

■ **URL:** <http://en.kremlin.ru/events/president/news/79756>

■ **Summary:**

The meeting was attended by Prime Minister Mikhail Mishustin, First Deputy Prime Minister Denis Manturov, Prime Minister of the Government of the Russian Federation, First Deputy Chief of Staff of the Presidential Executive Office Sergei Kiriyenko, Deputy Prime Minister Alexander Novak, Deputy Prime Minister of the Government of the Russian Federation, Deputy Chief of Staff of the Presidential Executive Office Maxim Oreshkin, Head of the Federal Taxation Service Daniil Yegorov, Head of the Federal Customs Service Valery Pikalev, and Deputy Governor of the Central Bank Alexei Zabotkin. * * * President of Russia Vladimir Putin: Good afternoon, colleagues, We are holding a regular meeting to discuss the current situation in the domestic economy. I would like to note right away that the recent measures and decisions implemented by the Government have begun to produce, in cautious terms, certain results, positive results. This is reflected in the positive statistical data for March. As Minister of Economic Development Maxim Reshetnikov recently reported, consumer activity was up in March. Wholesale trade grew by 8 percent, while retail trade increased by 6.2 percent. At the sam

19. US achieved total military victory over Iran -- Trump

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/world/2131519>

■ **Summary:**

The US leader considered it "treasonous" for journalists to write that Tehran is "doing well militarily" WASHINGTON, May 15. /TASS/. The United States has crushed Iran's military potential and thus achieved total victory, US President Donald Trump has stated. "We had a total military victory. We knocked out their entire navy, we knocked out their entire air force, we knocked out all of their anti-aircraft weaponry, we knocked out all of their radar, we knocked out all of their leaders," the US leader told journalists aboard his plane. At the same time, he told journalists from several media outlets, including CNN and The New York Times, that they "write incorrectly" about the US victory. Trump considered it "treasonous" for journalists to write that Tehran is "doing well militarily".

20. Gulf states mulling non-aggression pact with Iran - FT -- RT World News

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** RT

■ **URL:** <https://www.rt.com/news/640030-gulf-mulling-non-aggression-pact-iran/>

■ **Summary:**

Saudi Arabia has floated the idea of a landmark non-aggression pact between the Gulf states and Iran after the end of the US-Israeli war on Tehran, the Financial Times reported on Friday, citing diplomatic sources. Western diplomats told the newspaper that Riyadh is studying a model loosely inspired by the Helsinki Process, the Cold War-era talks that produced the 1975 Helsinki Accords on security and European cooperation, and succeeded in defusing tensions between the Soviet Union and Western nations led by the US. The idea is reportedly being weighed as Gulf states fear that

Iran - outraged by the devastating US-Israeli strikes but still a potent military power - will remain dangerous, especially if the US agrees to reduce its large regional footprint after the end of the war. According to the FT, the idea of an all-encompassing non-aggression pact was being floated before the US-Israeli attack, but the war gave it additional urgency. An unnamed Arab diplomat told the newspaper that most Arab and Muslim states, as well as Iran - which has long insisted that the US should leave the region - would probably welcome a Helsinki-style pact, but warned that Israel remains the elephant in the room. "In the current climate, you are not going to be able to get Iran and Israel... without Israel it could be counter-productive because after Iran, they are seen as the biggest source of conflict," the diplomat told the FT. "But Iran is not going anywhere and this is why the Saudis are pus

21. US Overseas Biolabs Probe Aims to Rein in 'Deep State' Bureaucracy

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Sputnik International

■ **URL:** <https://sputnikglobe.com/20260515/us-overseas-biolabs-probe-aims-to-rein-in-deep-state-bureaucracy-1124131207.html>

■ **Summary:**

"This is less about legal prosecution and more about the administration asserting control over the 'Deep State' bureaucracy and signaling a broader rapprochement with Moscow by validating some of their long-standing security grievances," says London-based foreign policy analyst Adriel Kasonta. When it comes to accountability, the development, spearheaded by DNI Tulsi Gabbard, "suggests a move toward 'America First' oversight rather than an admission of criminal activity by previous officials," the pundit believes. Earlier this week, Tulsi Gabbard announced an investigation into more than 120 US biolabs operating across 30-plus countries, including 40 in Ukraine, with a focus on potential "gain-of-function" research. The probe came on the heels of the indictment of a former advisor to top US health official Anthony Fauci, accused of unlawfully concealing federal records tied to the origins of COVID-19.

22. Top Iranian diplomat comments on Russia's uranium proposal, attempts to derail talks

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/world/2131501>

■ **Summary:**

Abbas Araghchi pointed to the Iranian authorities' efforts to maintain a ceasefire with the US in order to resolve the conflict diplomatically NEW DELHI, May 15. /TASS/. Tehran is ready to discuss Moscow's proposal for the transfer of Iran's enriched uranium to Russia but at a later stage, Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi said at a press conference in New Delhi. He pointed to the Iranian authorities' efforts to maintain a ceasefire with the US in order to resolve the conflict diplomatically. TASS has compiled the main points from the top diplomat's remarks. Tehran is ready to discuss Moscow's proposal for the transfer of enriched uranium to Russia but at a later stage: "When we come to that stage, obviously, we will have more consultations with Russia, and we'll see if the Russian offer can help or not; this is not something for the time being." Tehran is grateful to Moscow for offering assistance in the transfer of Iran's enriched uranium to Russia: "We are thankful to our Russian friends for their offer and for their intention to help resolve this problem." Iran's nuclear program is purely peaceful: "Iran has never wanted a nuclear weapon. We have said time and again that we don't want a nuclear weapon. We have a peaceful nuclear program." Some counties are trying to derail talks between Tehran and Washington and drag the US into war: "I hope that wisdom and diplomacy will finally prevail and we go in line of diplomacy to find a negotiated solution." The Iranian auth

23. Attempts to put pressure on Iran to unblock the Strait of Hormuz out of place -- Lavrov

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/politics/2131499>

■ Summary:

The Russian foreign minister underscored that the priority should be addressing the root causes of the conflict, which he affirmed are well understood globally NEW DELHI, May 15. /TASS/. Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov has dismissed attempts to pressure Tehran, particularly through Beijing, to unblock the Strait of Hormuz, calling such efforts inappropriate and misplaced. Speaking at a news conference following the BRICS ministerial meeting in New Delhi, Lavrov addressed comments made by US Secretary of State Marco Rubio regarding Washington's supposed plans to solicit China's help in pressuring Iran to end the Middle East conflict and reopen the vital waterway. Lavrov clarified that Russia has no knowledge of any such requests directed at China. "The Strait of Hormuz wasn't closed; it was completely open for shipping until February 28," he remarked. "That was when the US and Israel launched their second assault against Iran in six months." He questioned the rationale behind involving China, asking, "What does the People's Republic of China have to do with this? I find it difficult to understand what the Americans are demanding of China. First, they started something, reached a dead end, and now need to unblock energy supplies, fertilizers, and food through the Strait. Yet Iran is resistant. They want China to pressure Iran. It's a very primitive strategy, and I don't believe it reflects the standards of responsible international diplomacy." Lavrov underscored that the

24. Inconsistencies in US position biggest hurdle in negotiations -- Araghchi

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/world/2131503>

■ Summary:

According to the Iranian top diplomat, Washington has already realized that it cannot achieve any goals through military action against Iran NEW DELHI, May 15. /TASS/. The main difficulty in negotiations with the United States on resolving the conflict is the contradictory messages coming from Washington, Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi stated. "They will not be able to achieve their goals through military means, but if the path of diplomacy is chosen, the situation will be different. We have already started interacting, but, as you know, there are many problems on this path. The biggest problem is the contradictory signals we receive from the US side through various

statements, interviews, and the expression of official positions," he said in a commentary to the Indian television channel Doordarshan. According to Araghchi, Washington has already realized that it cannot achieve any goals through military action against Iran. On May 10, Iran delivered its response to US proposals on resolving the Persian Gulf conflict to Pakistan. According to sources cited by The Wall Street Journal, Tehran rejected Washington's demand to dismantle its nuclear facilities. The newspaper added that Iran was willing to suspend uranium enrichment, but not for 20 years like the United States is stipulating. US President Donald Trump later called Tehran's response unacceptable.

25. Russia's Battlegroup North UAVs destroy over dozen Ukrainian EW stations in Kharkov Region

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/defense/2131497>

■ **Summary:**

An attack UAV platoon commander, call sign "Funtik," noted that eliminating jamming stations and equipment the Russian military can more widely utilize various types of reconnaissance and attack drones BELGOROD, May 15. /TASS/. Unmanned aerial vehicle (UAV) forces of Russia's Battlegroup North's 6th Guards Combined Arms Army destroyed at least 15 electronic warfare (EW) stations of the Ukrainian armed forces in the Kharkov Region over the past week, an attack UAV platoon commander, call sign "Funtik," told TASS. "FPV drone operators of the Battlegroup North's 6th Guards Combined Arms Army' unmanned systems units destroyed more than 15 electronic warfare stations of Ukrainian militants in the Kharkov Region over the past week. Reconnaissance and attack UAV operators conduct surveillance and search for targets at enemy positions around the clock. Despite attempts to conceal their jamming equipment, experienced operators detect and destroy the stations," the officer said. He noted that eliminating jamming stations and equipment the Russian military can more widely utilize various types of reconnaissance and attack drones. "We try to destroy both the jamming stations themselves, the generators used to power them, and the militant personnel operating these stations," the officer added. Standard communications equipment is used to coordinate actions. Thanks to a high-quality connection, units' command and control is uninterrupted and running 24/7. Live recording is ensured via a st

26. Russia takes out 15 Ukrainian Maya UAVs loaded with C-4 headed for civilian sites

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/defense/2131487>

■ **Summary:**

According to the Russian military personnel, the UAVs were directed toward substations, hospitals, and communication towers located in large population centers across Russia MOSCOW, May 15. /TASS/. Over the past four days, units of the BARS-Bryansk volunteer unit, using a Moscow-made Yolka interceptor, destroyed 15 Ukrainian Maya drones carrying American-made C-4 explosives that were headed for various facilities in densely populated areas, the unit's fighters reported in a video obtained by TASS. "Over four days, crews from the BARS-Bryansk volunteer unit used the Moscow-made Yolka interceptor to engage 15 enemy targets - the Maya unmanned aerial vehicles (UAVs). American-made C-4 explosives were found in the drones. The Ukrainian armed forces' drones targeted hospitals, substations, and communication towers. The Maya is most often used by the enemy as a decoy drone to detect and overwhelm air defense systems. However, in this case, all 15 UAVs were deployed in strike configurations and posed a direct threat to facilities. The UAVs were directed toward substations, hospitals, and communication towers located in large population centers across Russia," the military personnel reported. Some of the drones detonated in the air after being hit by the Yolka, while others were spotted on the ground after being hit, and were subsequently defused. "An examination of the wreckage revealed that the drones contained a combined warhead: C-4, an American-made plastic explosive, and cast T

27. Russian troops liberate three communities in Ukraine operation over week -- top brass

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/politics/2131479>

■ **Summary:**

MOSCOW, May 15. /TASS/. Russian troops liberated three communities in the Kharkov and Zaporozhye Regions and the Donetsk People's Republic over the past week in the special military operation in Ukraine, Russia's Defense Ministry reported on Friday. "Yesterday, Battlegroup North units took control of the settlement of Chaikovka in the Kharkov Region through decisive operations. Battlegroup South units liberated the settlement of Nikolayevka in the Donetsk People's Republic in active offensive operations. Battlegroup East units kept advancing deeper into the enemy's defenses and liberated the settlement of Charivnoye in the Zaporozhye Region during the last 24-hour period," the ministry said in a statement. Russian troops delivered one massive and two combined strikes by precision weapons and unmanned aerial vehicles on Ukrainian military-industrial enterprises, energy and transport infrastructure over the period of May 12-15 in response to Kiev's attacks on civilian facilities, the ministry reported. "On May 12-15 of this year, in retaliation to Ukraine's terrorist attacks on civilian facilities on Russian territory, the Russian Armed Forces delivered one massive and two combined strikes by long-range precision weapons, including Kinzhal air-launched hypersonic ballistic missiles, and attack unmanned aerial vehicles, hitting enterprises of Ukraine's military-industrial sector, fuel and energy, transport and port infrastructure sites used by the Ukrainian army, military airforce

28. Trump must be patient if he wants to reach agreement with Iran -- Araghchi

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/world/2131475>

■ **Summary:**

The top Iranian diplomat responded to CNN reports suggesting that Donald Trump has grown frustrated over the closure of the Strait of Hormuz and Tehran's steadfast stance NEW DELHI, May 15. /TASS/. Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi has advised US President Donald Trump to exercise patience if Washington genuinely seeks to reach an agreement with Tehran. "It's not a matter of patience or not. This is a serious issue. If they want to find a solution, they must be

patient," Araghchi stated during a news conference in New Delhi. His comments came in response to CNN reports suggesting that Trump has grown frustrated over the closure of the Strait of Hormuz and Tehran's steadfast stance. On May 12, CNN reported that the US administration is increasingly contemplating the possibility of resuming full-scale military action against Iran.

29. Tatarstan announces investment project pipeline for OIC countries

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/economy/2131469>

■ **Summary:**

These projects can be divided into several areas: agro-industrial cluster, halal industry, food exports, industrial projects, and logistics hubs KAZAN, May 15. /TASS/. Russia's Republic of Tatarstan has compiled a bevy of investment projects to attract capital from Organization of Islamic Cooperation (OIC) countries, the republic's Deputy Prime Minister and Economy Minister Midkhat Shagiakhmetov said at the 17th International Economic Forum "Russia - Islamic World: KazanForum." "We have come up with a targeted pool of investment projects in the republic that are aimed at attracting capital from Organization of Islamic Cooperation countries," Shagiakhmetov said. According to him, investment projects can be divided into several areas: the agro-industrial cluster, the halal industry, food exports, industrial projects, logistics hubs, and others. The minister recalled that work is underway in the republic to develop partnership financing (Islamic banking). "We see the main goal of our initiative as creating conditions and a mechanism for attracting foreign investment from Islamic countries. To achieve this, we believe it is important to organize the circulation of halal financial instruments issued by large companies," Shagiakhmetov said. Islamic banking means conducting banking activities in accordance with Islamic norms. Payment of interest and derivative interest transactions, transactions with conditions of uncertainty, as well as financing of certain sectors of the economy s

30. BRICS New Development Bank could become international 'bank of innovation' -- PM Mishustin

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/economy/2131465>

■ **Summary:**

The head of the Russian government recalled that the BRICS share in global GDP had already reached 40% MOSCOW, May 15. /TASS/. The BRICS New Development Bank (NDB) has the necessary potential to become an international "bank of innovation," Russian Prime Minister Mikhail Mishustin said at the 11th meeting of the NDB Board of Governors. "The NDB has everything necessary to become an international 'bank of innovation' -- to help countries identify key areas of focus, select the best development instruments, and create conditions under which businesses will be ready to invest at early stages and for the long term," he said. The head of the Russian government recalled that the BRICS share in global GDP has already reached 40%, "which is significantly higher than that of the Group of Seven or the European Union." "This gap is expected to continue widening amid the ongoing restructuring of the economy and logistics routes," Mishustin noted. As a result, he continued, the role of interstate associations acting in the interests of the Global South is increasing. The BRICS New Development Bank has already approved projects worth more than \$40 bln. "This is a concrete contribution to the modernization of transport, energy, and public utility infrastructure," the Russian prime minister emphasized. The NDB was established by BRICS countries under an intergovernmental agreement signed at the bloc's 6th summit in Fortaleza in July 2014. Its purpose is to finance infrastructure and sustaina

31. Israeli West Bank occupation an affront to Nakba Day legacy (RT reports) -- RT World News

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** RT

■ **URL:** <https://www.rt.com/news/640018-palestinians-nakba-rt/>

■ Summary:

Residents say settlement expansion and military operations are forcing more communities from their homes. Palestinians mark 78 years since the Nakba on Friday - one of the largest refugee crises in modern history - as expanding Israeli settlements and military operations are again forcing communities from their homes, RT's Charlotte Dubenskij reports. The Nakba, or 'catastrophe', was triggered by the mass displacement of Palestinians during the creation of Israel in 1948. A 1947 UN partition plan, adopted with backing from the Soviet Union, called for the creation of separate Jewish and Arab states, but only Israel was established. The Israeli-Palestinian conflict, rooted in competing territorial claims, has fueled decades of unrest and wars in the Middle East. Activists and local residents told RT that pressure on Palestinians is intensifying across areas under Israeli control. The UN says around 40,000 Palestinians have been displaced in the West Bank since early 2025 amid intensified Israeli military operations, demolitions, and settler violence. Members of Bedouin communities interviewed by RT described repeated attempts to force them from their land. "When we first came here, they told us this was Area B, Palestinian land. But then they turned around and told us, no, you are not allowed to stay here either," one resident said. "Every single day, they come after us trying to force us out." Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov said on Friday that prospects for the creatio

32. Moscow Signals Possible Strikes on European Drone Production Sites

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** PravdaReport

■ **URL:** <https://english.pravda.ru/news/world/166737-russia-preemptive-strikes-europe/>

■ Summary:

Russia could begin carrying out preemptive strikes against facilities in Europe that manufacture drones for Ukraine after the large-scale attack on the city of Ryazan, Andrey Kolesnik, a member of the Russian State Duma Defense Committee said. Speaking to Gazeta.ru, Kolesnik argued that Moscow should start identifying and potentially targeting production sites connected to Ukrainian drone attacks on Russian territory. "It's already time to carry out preemptive strikes. It's time to start looking closely at where the drones that strike our territory and our civilian population are being produced. That is Europe," Kolesnik stated. According to the Russian lawmaker, European

countries have effectively become logistical and industrial support hubs for Ukraine's military drone campaign. He added that Russia already possesses plans concerning possible strikes on such facilities, although the timing of any operation would ultimately depend on decisions made by the country's military leadership. The comments came after Ukrainian drones attacked the Russian city of Ryazan during the night of May 15. Regional governor Pavel Malkov said falling debris from intercepted drones damaged several residential buildings. Footage circulating online showed the aftermath of one drone impact on a multi-story apartment building. According to Russian authorities, three people were killed in the attack and at least 12 others were injured. The Russian Health Ministry later clarified that seven victims,

33. Ex-Georgian Economy Minister appointed CEO of SOCAR-acquired Italian petroleum company

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** OC Media

■ **URL:** <https://oc-media.org/ex-georgian-economy-minister-appointed-ceo-of-socar-acquired-italian-petroleum-company/>

■ **Summary:**

Former Georgian Economy Minister Levan Davitashvili has been appointed CEO at the Italian petroleum company Italiana Petroli (IP). The management change was announced by the Azerbaijani state-run energy giant SOCAR, which recently completed the acquisition of IP. In its Wednesday press release, SOCAR noted that 'Davitashvili will lead the operations of IP in Italy, with the focus of ensuring operational continuity, preserving and further strengthening its position in the national energy market, and overseeing the company's integration within the broader SOCAR Group'. 'The appointment reflects SOCAR's commitment to Italy through dedicated leadership that combines the Group's international industrial expertise and strategic vision with a strong understanding of the local market and institutional environment', SOCAR added. The company further noted that Davitashvili 'brings over 25 years of experience across senior public and private sector leadership positions'. Alongside with his ministership, SOCAR emphasised that Davitashvili 'guided the country's involvement in the Green Energy Corridor initiative, connecting the South Caucasus to European Union member states'. 'Since November 2025, he has served as Advisor to the President of SOCAR', the press release read. Azerbaijan's SOCAR signed an agreement to

acquire IP, one of Italy's major fuel station networks, in September 2025. The process was completed in May, after SOCAR received the necessary regulatory approvals. Davitashvil

34. Polish Pianist on Trial for Alleged Russian Espionage

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** PravdaReport

■ **URL:** <https://english.pravda.ru/news/world/166736-poland-pianist-russia-spying/>

■ **Summary:**

Turkey Launches First Yeni Tip Landing Ship After Rapid 18-Month Construction In the District Court of Bydgoszcz, prosecutors are trying 28-year-old Polish citizen Wiktor Z., who stands accused of spying for Russian intelligence. According to investigators, he allegedly showed interest in cooperation during an interrogation at the Belarusian border crossing in Brest, where he traveled with an acquaintance visiting his homeland, Gazeta Wyborcza said. According to the prosecution, Wiktor Z. collected and attempted to pass along information last spring regarding the NATO Joint Force Training Center, Bydgoszcz Airport, the Military Aviation Works facility, and the Nitro-Chem enterprise -- a strategic TNT producer for NATO countries. However, prosecutors claim the information never reached Russian intelligence services. Instead, Polish authorities themselves became the recipients of the material. By education, Wiktor Z. is a pianist. He also graduated from the Faculty of Applied Linguistics and speaks both German and Russian fluently. According to court testimony, he maintained a deep fascination with Russia. He was also actively involved in ASG, a military tactical game similar to paintball. Through this hobby, he met a woman named Marta, whom he reportedly tried to impress. She later appeared in court as a witness. According to Wiktor, he traveled to Belarus for tourism purposes together with a Belarusian acquaintance named Valery and Valery's then-girlfriend Darya. "He said som

35. Modi confirmed visit to Russia this year - Lavrov -- RT India

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** RT

■ **URL:** <https://www.rt.com/india/640020-modi-visit-russia-this-year/>

■ **Summary:**

Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi has confirmed that he will visit Moscow later this year, Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov said on Friday. Modi and Lavrov met a day earlier and discussed a broad bilateral agenda. Russia's top diplomat is on a two-day visit to New Delhi to attend the BRICS foreign ministers' meeting. "Prime Minister Narendra Modi has confirmed that this year it is his turn to pay a visit to the Russian Federation. We will be preparing for this meeting," Lavrov said. He also noted that Russian President Vladimir Putin is likely to visit New Delhi for the BRICS leaders' summit later this year. During his bilateral interactions in New Delhi, the Russian foreign minister discussed ways to further strengthen cooperation in trade, economy and investment "in such a way that we don't depend on the negative, unfriendly pressure from third party countries," Lavrov stated. "We agreed to strengthen transport cooperation, including the development of the international north south transport corridor and the northern sea route and we also talked about the steps that are being taken to improve the system of direct mutual settlements and the increased supply of Russian energy and fertilizers," he noted. Nuclear energy, including plans to build new nuclear power reactors in India in addition to the ongoing Kudankulam project, cooperation in defense manufacturing and space exploration also figured in the talks. To a question about whether Moscow is supplying more oil to

36. Putin's test for Europe, Nazi revival, US-China relations: Lavrov's statements

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/politics/2131391>

■ **Summary:**

Russia will not be drawn into any triangulation attempts by the US to pit Moscow and Beijing against one another, the Russian foreign minister said NEW DELHI, May 15. /TASS/. Russian President Vladimir Putin tested the EU for political sensitivity by proposing former German Chancellor Gerhard Schroder as a candidate for negotiator with Moscow from the Europeans, Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov said at a press conference following a BRICS ministerial meeting in the Indian capital

of New Delhi. According to him, Germany is once again leading the movement in support of Nazism in Europe, with Vladimir Zelensky appointed as its leader. TASS has compiled the key statements of the head of the Foreign Ministry. The situation in the Middle East and North Africa region is becoming increasingly complex: "We paid special attention to crisis situations in the Middle East, including the Strait of Hormuz, Iran, Lebanon, the Palestinian territories, where even prospects for a Palestinian state are being eliminated in violation of United Nations resolutions, as well as Libya, Yemen, and Syria. These conflicts are creating a web of contradictions that is making the situation in the Middle East and North Africa increasingly complicated." This is due to "Western interference in sovereign states." Russia will not be drawn into any triangulation attempts by the US to pit Moscow and Beijing against one another: "I believe [former US Secretary of State] Henry Kissinger once argued that Washin

37. Kremlin closely monitors media reports on Trump's visit to China

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/politics/2131399>

■ **Summary:**

Dmitry Peskov said upcoming Russia-China contacts would allow the sides to exchange views on recent talks between Chinese and US officials MOSCOW, May 15. /TASS/. The Kremlin is closely monitoring media reports on US President Donald Trump's visit to China and hopes to receive information firsthand during Russian President Vladimir Putin's upcoming trip there, Kremlin Spokesman Dmitry Peskov said at a briefing. "We are closely monitoring media reports and hope to get this information firsthand when we visit China," he said. Peskov said upcoming Russia-China contacts would allow the sides to exchange views on recent talks between Chinese and US officials. "Direct dialogue between the world's two largest economies at the highest level naturally draws close attention from all countries, including Russia. China is the world's largest economy by purchasing power parity, while the United States ranks first in absolute terms," Peskov added.

38. West applies double standards by justifying blatant aggression -- Tatarstan head

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/politics/2131395>

■ **Summary:**

Rustam Minnikhanov noted that the world was undergoing a complex process of transition toward a multipolar order KAZAN, May 15. /TASS/. The West is demonstrating double standards by failing to condemn -- and even attempting to justify -- blatant aggression, the head of the Tatarstan Region, Rustam Minnikhanov, said at a meeting of the Russia-Islamic World Strategic Vision Group in Kazan. "Today, the world is undergoing a complex process of transition toward a multipolar order. This has provoked open hostility from a number of powers that gained economic and political advantages through the exploitation of other countries' resources and have grown accustomed to the logic of global domination. In an effort to preserve the status quo, they employ a broad range of coercive measures, including sanctions, blackmail, and threats of military force. The imposition of ideological frameworks that contradict traditional spiritual values has become one of the forms of interference in the affairs of sovereign states. The concept of a rules-based world order has resulted in US-Israeli aggression against Iran and the subsequent spread of armed confrontation across the Middle East. This has been accompanied by the destruction of infrastructure and the disruption of international cooperation networks built over decades. At the same time, the so-called collective West is once again demonstrating double standards by failing to condemn and even justifying blatant aggression," Minnikhanov said. He

39. Russia's relations with Islamic countries strengthen over past 20 years -- Tatarstan head

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/politics/2131387>

■ Summary:

Rustam Minnikhanov stressed that an important factor in further strengthening relations was not only a shared approach to key global issues, but also a common system of moral values KAZAN, May 15. /TASS/. Over the past 20 years, relations between Russia and the member states of the Organization of Islamic Cooperation (OIC) have become more comprehensive and multifaceted, Rustam Minnikhanov, head of the Tatarstan Region, said at a meeting of the Russia-Islamic World Strategic Vision Group in Kazan. "This year, we are gathering to mark a significant milestone -- the 20th anniversary of the group's founding. At the turn of the second millennium, major changes began sweeping through the global system of international relations, with the emergence of a new multipolar world order becoming a key trend. Relations between Russia and the member states of the Organization of Islamic Cooperation have become more constructive and have taken on a comprehensive and multilateral character," Minnikhanov said. He recalled that, at the initiative of President Vladimir Putin, Russia was granted observer status in the OIC. According to Minnikhanov, over the past two decades, cooperation has expanded to include security, counterterrorism, the economy, humanitarian initiatives, cultural exchanges, and interfaith dialogue. The head of Tatarstan stressed that an important factor in further strengthening relations is not only a shared approach to key global issues, but also a common system of moral va

40. The Missile Age -- RT

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** RT

■ **URL:** <https://www.rt.com/trends/missile-age/>

■ Summary:

Missiles have become the defining weapon of the 21st century. They sink warships, level critical infrastructure, and serve as bargaining chips in high-stakes diplomacy. From the deserts of the Middle East to the battlefields of Eastern Europe, missile arsenals are reshaping both the conduct of war and the global balance of power. In this special series for RT, military analyst Dmitry Kornev examines the missile capabilities of the world's key players - from Russia and Ukraine to China, the US, Europe, Asia, and the post-Soviet space. Each article offers a deep dive into how nations develop, test, and deploy these weapons - and what their arsenals reveal about the conflicts and rivalries of tomorrow.

41. China interested in freedom of navigation through Strait of Hormuz -- US trade envoy

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/world/2131377>

■ **Summary:**

Jamieson Greer described China's approach to relations with Iran as "very pragmatic" NEW YORK, May 15. /TASS/. China expresses interest in freedom of navigation through the Strait of Hormuz and seeks peace in the Middle East, said US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer who was part of the American delegation in Beijing. "It's really important for China to have the Strait of Hormuz open, no tolling, no military control, and that was clear from the meeting. So we welcome that," he said on air of Bloomberg TV. The official described China's approach to relations with Iran as "very pragmatic." "They want see peace in that area. President [of US Donald] Trump wants to see peace in that area. So we have a lot of confidence that they will do what they can to limit any kind of material support for Iran," he said.

42. Press review: China, US temper rivalry and Yermak case hides Ukraine corruption underbelly

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/pressreview/2131157>

■ **Summary:**

The case against former Vladimir Zelensky office head Andrey Yermak is an attempt to make him the fall guy so as to shield the rest of Kiev's corrupt officials and those backing them in the West, Russian Foreign Ministry Spokeswoman Maria Zakharova told Izvestia. According to her, the criminal chain includes not only members of the government, parliament, Western envoys, but also

Zelensky himself. The head of the Kiev regime was aware of all the shadow schemes, experts believe. On May 13, Ukraine's High Anti-Corruption Court ordered former presidential office chief Andrey Yermak to be held in pre-trial detention for two months with the possibility of release on bail set at 140 mln hryvnias, or more than \$3 mln. "This is not even the tip of the iceberg. It is an operation to rescue the remaining Kiev corrupt officials and those standing behind them in the West," Russian Foreign Ministry Spokeswoman Maria Zakharova told Izvestia. "Everyone knows that this corruption chain consists of a huge number of links: Zelensky, his entire government, the parliament, Western envoys, and so on," she added. Notably, Zelensky has so far refrained from commenting on the case involving his close associate. Only a muted reaction came from adviser Dmitry Litvin, who stated that it was still too early to draw conclusions while procedural actions were ongoing. Former Verkhovna Rada deputy Vladimir Oleynik believes that Zelensky's wife Elena could become the next target of the investigation, while Z

43. Russia does not interfere in relations between third countries -- Lavrov

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/politics/2131341>

■ **Summary:**

The Russian foreign minister added that Moscow does not utilize the "divide and conquer" principle NEW DELHI, May 15. /TASS/. Moscow does not interfere in trade relations between third countries, Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov said at a press conference following a BRICS ministerial meeting in the Indian capital of New Delhi. According to a White House statement, Chinese President Xi Jinping, at a meeting with US leader Donald Trump, expressed an interest in increasing US oil purchases in order to reduce China's dependence on the situation surrounding the Strait of Hormuz. In this regard, the top Russian diplomat was asked if broad cooperation between the US and China, as announced by Washington, was actually aimed at driving a wedge between Moscow and Beijing. "We don't interfere in trade relations between third countries. We have far-reaching agreements with China, enshrined in contracts, intergovernmental treaties and accords in almost all areas of cooperation, such as trade, economic and investment fields, including energy supplies. Based on these agreements, we faithfully fulfill all our obligations," Lavrov pointed out. "Notably, we

don't ask the Chinese to consult us on their plans for relations with other countries, nor does China make such inappropriate requests to us," he added. "That said, if the agreements that have been or will be reached by Beijing and Washington serve the interests of our Chinese friends, we will only be happy for them," the top Russian

44. Iran guarantees safe passage through Hormuz Strait for all vessels after end of war -- MFA

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/world/2131305>

■ **Summary:**

Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi stressed that complete cessation of hostilities is the only solution NEW DELHI, May 15. /TASS/. Iranian authorities are ready to guarantee safe passage through the Strait of Hormuz for all commercial vessels once the war with the United States ends, Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi said. "The only solution [to the issue of passage through the Strait of Hormuz] is a complete cessation of the aggressive war [waged by the US against Iran], after which we will guarantee safe passage for every vessel," he said in a comment to the Indian television channel Doordarshan. On February 28, the United States and Israel launched military strikes against Iran. Major Iranian cities, including Tehran, came under attack. In response, the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps announced a large-scale retaliatory operation and launched strikes on Israel. US military facilities in Bahrain, Jordan, Iraq, Qatar, Kuwait, the UAE, and Saudi Arabia were also targeted. Iranian authorities subsequently announced the closure of the Strait of Hormuz to vessels associated with the United States, Israel, and countries that supported the attacks against the Islamic Republic.

45. Trump policies mean Europe is 'alone' - ex-ECB chief -- RT World News

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** RT

■ **URL:** <https://www.rt.com/news/640019-trump-policies-europe-alone-draghi/>

■ **Summary:**

US President Donald Trump's increasingly "confrontational and unpredictable" policies have left Europe "truly alone together" and unable to rely on Washington as its main security guarantor, former Italian prime minister and ex-ECB chief Mario Draghi has warned. Draghi made the remarks in Aachen, Germany, on Thursday while receiving the Charlemagne Prize for his "historic services" to European integration and competitiveness. Using his speech to outline how Europe can survive the "new realities," Draghi warned the bloc could no longer depend on the US. "The world that once helped Europe generate prosperity no longer exists. It has become harder, more fragmented and more mercantilist... The central external fact of our time: our relationship with the US has changed," Draghi said. He argued that Washington is increasingly making unilateral decisions with major consequences for Europe, citing Trump's tariffs introduced last year, which resulted in a trade deal widely viewed in Europe as humiliating, as well as the US-Israeli war on Iran launched without consultation with European allies. Draghi said the conflict, which effectively blocked the Strait of Hormuz - the route for roughly 20% of global oil and LNG supplies - "brought inflation back into our economies and anxiety back into our households." At the same time, Draghi described the shift in US policy as a "necessary wake-up call." "In a world of evolving partnerships, every strategic dependency must now be re-examined. For

46. Ukrainian Intelligence Increasingly Attempts to Destabilize Russian Society - Russian Foreign Intel

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Sputnik International

■ **URL:** <https://sputnikglobe.com/20260515/ukrainian-intelligence-increasingly-attempts-to-destabilize-russian-society--russian-foreign-intel-1124130609.html>

■ **Summary:**

https://cdn1.img.sputnikglobe.com/img/07e7/08/06/1112419155_0:215:2879:1834_1920x0_80_0_0_e4dbefaf270878e72be7d46cbe93eae6.jpg.webp"According to the information received by the

SVR, Ukrainian intelligence agencies have recently stepped up their attempts to destabilize Russian society," the statement read. Kiev already has a widespread network of telephone scammers who use deception, blackmail and extortion to rob Russian citizens of their savings and manipulate them to break the law, the SVR added. The Security Service of Ukraine (SBU) intends to launch an operation to destabilize the situation in Russia under the guise of spreading patriotic content, the statement added. The SVR noted that in late April, Ukrainian agents started buying Russian military and patriotic-themed Telegram channels.

47. Body of second US soldier missing in Morocco recovered -- RT Africa

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** RT

■ **URL:** <https://www.rt.com/africa/640015-body-second-us-soldier-missing-african-lion-drill-morocco-recovered/>

■ **Summary:**

Spc. Mariyah Symone Collington's remains were discovered in a cave around 500 meters from where she reportedly entered the Atlantic Ocean. The remains of the second US soldier who went missing during the African Lion military exercise in Morocco has been recovered after nearly two weeks of search operations involving more than 1,000 military and civilian personnel. The US Army Europe and Africa announced on Wednesday that the body of Spc. Mariyah Symone Collington of Tavares, Florida was found on May 12 in a coastal cave around 500 meters from where she reportedly entered the Atlantic Ocean. Collington, 19, and her colleague 1st Lieutenant Kendrick Lamont Key Jr., 27, went missing on May 2 near Morocco's Cap Draa Training Area outside Tan-Tan, a remote coastal zone of cliffs and desert plains. The two had participated in African Lion 2026 but were reportedly off duty during a recreational hike when they fell from a cliff. Key's body was recovered on May 9 around one mile from where the two soldiers were believed to have entered the water, according to the US Army. The army said the recovery operation spanned more than 21,300 square km and involved over 1,000 US and Moroccan personnel, deploying aircraft, drones, surface vessels, divers, mountaineers, and ground teams. Collington served as an air and missile defense crew member with Charlie Battery, 5th Battalion, 4th Air Defense Artillery Regiment, 10th Army Air and Missile Defense Command. She joined active duty in 2024 and h

48. Russia's Battlegroup North FPV drones kill Ukrainian contingent in Sumy Region

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/defense/2131283>

■ **Summary:**

Airborne reconnaissance capabilities of the units detected the movement of a group of enemy personnel near a forest belt in the Sumy Region KURSK, May 15. /TASS/. An FPV drone crew of Russia's Battlegroup North's 56th Guards Airborne Assault Regiment has eliminated a group of Ukrainian soldiers near a forest belt in the Sumy Region, the unmanned aerial vehicle (UAV) crew commander, call sign "Pushkin," told TASS. "Airborne reconnaissance capabilities of the units detected the movement of a group of enemy personnel near a forest belt in the Sumy Region. After analyzing the intelligence, a decision was made to engage the enemy. All targets were destroyed," the UAV crew commander said. The officer added that the communications and command and control systems of the unmanned systems forces allow them to carry out assigned missions. "UAV crews continue to engage enemy weapons, equipment, military facilities, and personnel on a daily basis, which is recorded in real-time mode," he noted.

49. Lavrov expects Russia, US to confirm Alaska agreements, 'better sooner than later'

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/politics/2131267>

■ **Summary:**

The top Russian diplomat said there are still a lot of issues that require detailed consideration MOSCOW, May 15. /TASS/. The agreements that were reached at the Russia-US summit in

Anchorage, Alaska, need to be confirmed, "better sooner than later," Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov said. "The spirit of the summit aside, certain understandings and, if you will, even agreements on the basic settlement principles were reached in Alaska, which had been put forward by the US and backed by Russia," he pointed out. "I only want to make it clear once again that it did not mean everything would be resolved once we made the Anchorage decisions public. What was agreed at the meeting were basic principles. There are still a lot of issues that require detailed consideration, which will become possible as soon as we confirm the Alaska agreements. I hope this will happen, better sooner than later," Lavrov added. In this regard, Lavrov highlighted Russian President Vladimir Putin's remark that Moscow "will achieve the goals of its special military operation under any circumstances." "We would prefer to use diplomatic means. However, if that's impossible, we will continue to pursue our goals through the special military operation," he stressed. The top Russian diplomat also noted that after the Alaska summit, "the Europeans, [Vladimir] Zelensky - naturally, he is always there - and especially London are doing everything they can to prevent the US from staying true to its own initiative

50. The Horn of Africa: Between Peace and War

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Valdai Club

■ **URL:** <https://valdaiclub.com/a/highlights/the-horn-of-africa-between-peace-and-war/>

■ **Summary:**

Two coalitions of states have taken shape in the Horn of Africa, with extra-regional actors also playing a notable role. The division into opposing blocs is rooted in key questions of the region's security and development: the national self-determination of peoples, the demarcation and delimitation of interstate borders, the right of landlocked states to access the open sea, and the establishment of a fair legal regime for water use, writes Maxim Shepovalenko, Deputy Director of the Centre for Analysis of Strategies and Technologies (CAST). For global trade, the Horn of Africa is as significant a region as the Persian Gulf, while the Bab el-Mandeb, much like the Strait of Hormuz, functions as a regional chokepoint. Against the backdrop of the current crisis in the Persian Gulf, foreign policy dynamics in the Horn of Africa may appear less alarming, yet beneath the surface of relative calm lie mounting interstate contradictions which, under certain conditions, could escalate into an acute regional conflict with consequences for the international community

comparable to those seen in the Middle East. At present, two coalitions of states have emerged in the Horn of Africa , with extra-regional actors playing a visible role. The division between them is grounded in the key issues of regional security and development: national self-determination, the demarcation and delimitation of interstate borders, the right of landlocked countries to access the open sea, and the establishment

51. Risk of US-Ukraine military-biological research misuse persists -- governor

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/politics/2131233>

■ **Summary:**

The network itself and its materials could have been redistributed to facilities in territories that remain under the control of the Kiev regime and its Western overseers, Vladimir Saldo said GENICHESK, May 15. /TASS/. The US-Ukraine biolabs saga is not over, Kherson Region Governor Vladimir Saldo told TASS. "There is no reason to consider this threat closed. The Russian Ministry of Defense stated that a significant part of the documentation, biomaterials, and equipment from laboratories in Kiev, Kharkov, and Odessa were evacuated to the Lvov Research Institute of Epidemiology and Hygiene and the American consulate in Lvov. It also can't be ruled out that part of the collection was transferred to Poland. This means that the network itself and its materials could have been redistributed to facilities in territories that remain under the control of the Kiev regime and its Western overseers," Saldo said. Earlier, US Director of National Intelligence Tulsi Gabbard announced the start of an investigation into more than 120 biological laboratories abroad that were funded by US taxpayer dollars for decades, as part of an effort to end potentially risky experiments with viruses pursuant to President Trump's executive order on so-called "gain-of-function" research. According to the New York Post, more than 40 such labs are located in Ukraine. According to Russian Deputy Foreign Minister Dmitry Lyubinsky, Washington and Kiev implemented a military biological program in Ukraine, and the

52. A fighter from North Ossetia was killed in the SVO zone.

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Caucasian Knot

■ **URL:** <https://www.eng.kavkaz-uzel.eu/articles/75253>

■ **Summary:**

Artur Tuaev was killed in combat. Since the beginning of the military operation in Ukraine, at least 587 fighters from North Ossetia have been officially recognized as killed. As reported by the "Caucasian Knot," by May 8, authorities and security forces had recognized at least 586 fighters from North Ossetia as killed in the military operation zone in Ukraine. Artur Tuayev, a native of the Prigorodny district, born in 1978, was killed in the North Ossetian military operation zone, the district administration announced today on its Telegram channel, announcing the date and location of the farewell ceremony. The administration did not provide details about the fighter's biography or death. Thus, at least 587 fighters from North Ossetia have been officially recognized as killed in the military operation. The "Caucasian Knot" is maintaining a list of names of natives of the North Caucasus and Southern Federal Districts killed in the military operation. The list is based on data officially released by government officials and security agencies, according to the "Caucasian Knot" report "North Ossetian Military District Statistics: Casualties Risen in Southern Russia". State awards, memorial plaques, and appearances on Channel One do not guarantee state support for the families of those killed, according to the Caucasian Knot article "Three Comrades Served: How the Authorities Are Depriving the Families of Killed Volunteers of Benefits," which describes the stories of fighters from

53. No reason for Iran conflict to continue -- Chinese MFA

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/world/2131139>

■ **Summary:**

According to the statement, a swift resolution of the situation would benefit both the United States and Iran BEIJING, May 15. /TASS/. There is no reason for the Iran conflict to continue, while an

early settlement would benefit both Tehran and Washington, the Chinese Foreign Ministry said in a statement. "The conflict, which should have never happened, has no reason to continue. A swift resolution of the situation would benefit both the United States and Iran, as well as the countries of the region and the entire world," the statement reads. The United States and Israel launched a military operation against Iran on February 28. On April 7, Washington announced a "double-sided" two-week ceasefire with Iran. On April 11, the parties held several rounds of talks in the Pakistani capital of Islamabad. According to both Tehran and Washington, they were unable to agree on a long-term solution to the conflict due to multiple disagreements. On April 21, the US president announced plans to extend the ceasefire with Iran. According to Iran's state broadcaster, Tehran does not intend to recognize Washington's unilateral ceasefire extension but will act in accordance with national interests.

54. Over 700 Ukrainian militants sentenced in Russia since start of special military-op

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/society/2131133>

■ **Summary:**

Head of the Russian Military Investigative Directorate Konstantin Korpusov said that 24 criminals were sentenced to life MOSCOW, May 15. /TASS/. Over 700 Ukrainian militants have been handed severe sentences since the start of Russia's special military operation, including 24 sentenced to life, Head of the Russian Military Investigative Directorate Konstantin Korpusov told TASS. "As a result of our work, over 700 Nazi criminals were sentenced to severe punishments, including 24, who were sentenced to life, while the rest were sentenced to between 16 and 25 years in prison," Korpusov said. According to earlier reports, Russian military investigators initiated over 2,000 criminal cases against representatives of the armed formations of Ukraine.

55. A Dagestani soldier was killed in Ukraine.

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Caucasian Knot

■ **URL:** <https://www.eng.kavkaz-uzel.eu/articles/75251>

■ **Summary:**

Eyvaz Yarakhmedov from the Tabasaran district was killed in a military operation. Since its beginning, at least 1,935 soldiers from Dagestan have been officially recognized as killed. As reported by the "Caucasian Knot," by May 14, officials and security forces had recognized at least 1,934 servicemen from Dagestan as killed in combat in Ukraine. A memorial plaque was unveiled at the Ushnigg school in the Tabasaran district in honor of Eyvaz Yarakhmedov, a school graduate killed during a special military operation, district head Magomed Kurbanov reported on his Telegram channel. Yarakhmedov was born on January 24, 1983, in the village of Ushnigg. He attended Ushnih Secondary School. From 2024, he served in the North Caucasus Military District and fought in the Luhansk sector. He was killed during a combat mission and buried in his home village in January 2026. Thus, at least 1,935 combatants from Dagestan have been officially recognized as killed in Ukraine. The "Caucasian Knot" maintains a list of names of natives of the North Caucasus and Southern Federal Districts killed in the military operation. The list was compiled based on data officially released by government officials and security agencies, according to the "Caucasian Knot" report "Northeastern Military District Statistics: Losses Are Growing in Southern Russia." On May 13, the name of another native of the Tabasaran district of Dagestan killed in Ukraine was revealed - Seymur Mirzabalaev. Dagestan ranks first among

56. West uses Baltic region as springboard to practice Russia's containment -- diplomat

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/politics/2131115>

■ **Summary:**

Deputy Foreign Minister Alexander Grushko says various coalitions are "attempting approaching the Arctic" MOSCOW, May 15. /TASS/. The Baltic region is used today by the West as a springboard for

training mechanisms to escalate ongoing developments and contain Russia, Russian Deputy Foreign Minister Alexander Grushko said in an interview with Russia's Izvestia daily. "This region used to be the most peaceful in terms of military activities," Grushko said. "There were no conflicts, neither frozen nor unfrozen. There were no prerequisites for increasing tensions at all." "The Baltic region is used today by the West as a laboratory [to study] how to escalate the situation and how to contain Russia from various regional and geographical directions," Grushko noted. "At the moment, they are attempting approaching the Arctic while various coalitions are being formed," he continued. "This is definitely an extremely worrying development. This development, this line, is completely inconsistent with the fundamental interests of the state and the peoples who are members of the Arctic union," Grushko noted. "I can't help but recall the slogan of the Norwegian presidency [of the Arctic Council] - 'high latitudes - low tension.' These words sound very beautiful, but in fact, the practical meaning pursued by our Western adversaries is to turn the Arctic into an arena of military confrontation," the Russian diplomat concluded.

57. A soldier was convicted in Nalchik for failing to report to his unit.

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Caucasian Knot

■ **URL:** <https://www.eng.kavkaz-uzel.eu/articles/75249>

■ **Summary:**

A court in Nalchik sentenced Astemir Maremukov to five years in prison for evading military service during mobilization. As reported by "Caucasian Knot," on September 24, 2022, Parts 2.1, 3.1, and 5 of Article 337, concerning unauthorized abandonment of a unit or place of service during mobilization, were amended to the Russian Criminal Code. The amendments provide for imprisonment for up to 10 years. Tightening of legislation after the announcement of mobilization led to harsher sentences for absence from a military unit or desertion. A serviceman named Maremukov was found guilty under Part 5 of Article 337 of the Criminal Code of the Russian Federation, the Nalchik Garrison Military Court reported on its VKontakte page. According to the court, Maremukov failed to report to his military unit without good reason "on December 9, 2025, that is, during the mobilization period." "On February 17, 2026, Maremukov voluntarily reported to the military investigative department in Nalchik, and from December 9 From 2025 to February 17, 2026, he spent his time at his own discretion at his place of residence," the publication says. In court, the

defendant "expressed regret for his actions" and pleaded guilty. Maremukov was sentenced to five years in prison, and he will serve his sentence in a general regime penal colony. The court's press service did not disclose the name of the convicted man. According to the case file on the court's website, the convicted man is Astemir Maremukov. The

58. US, Israel betrayed diplomacy, and Tehran 'does not trust them' -- Iranian diplomat

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/world/2131111>

■ **Summary:**

Ambassador to Belarus Alireza Sanei says the other side of the negotiations "wants everything in their favor" MINSK, May 15. /TASS/. The United States and Israel have betrayed diplomacy and negotiations, and this is why Tehran does not trust them, Iranian Ambassador to Belarus Alireza Sanei told TASS. "We believe in negotiations and diplomacy," he said. "We are not running away from it, we are not dodging it." "But if the other side wants everything in their favor, in their own interests, practically wants you to give up everything, then this no longer can be called negotiations," Sanei continued. The Iranian ambassador emphasized that during the February talks, Iran put forward "very good proposals regarding the nuclear program," but the United States and Israel "betrayed diplomacy and negotiations." "And they betrayed us, so we don't trust Israel and the Americans in any way," the diplomat said. The United States and Israel launched a military operation against Iran on February 28. Tehran decided to close the Strait of Hormuz to ships associated with the US, Israel and countries that backed the aggression against Iran. On April 7, Washington announced a "double-sided" two-week ceasefire with Iran. On April 11, the parties held several rounds of talks in the Pakistani capital of Islamabad. According to both Tehran and Washington, they were unable to reach a long-term settlement to the conflict due to multiple disagreements. On April 21, US President Donald Trump announced th

59. The names of two Dagestani soldiers killed in Ukraine have been released.

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Caucasian Knot

■ **URL:** <https://www.eng.kavkaz-uzel.eu/articles/75246>

■ **Summary:**

Gasulbeg Sharamazanov and Nurmagomed Abakarov from the Botlikh District were killed in combat. Since the beginning of the Russian operation in Ukraine, authorities have officially acknowledged at least 1,934 combatants from Dagestan killed there. As reported by the "Caucasian Knot," by May 14, officials and security forces acknowledged at least 1,932 servicemen from Dagestan killed in combat in Ukraine. The names of two more Dagestan soldiers killed in Ukraine were announced on May 14 by the Botlikh District administration, which reported the installation of memorial plaques in the Memory Square in Botlikh. The dead were Gasulbeg Sharamazanov from the village of Andi and Nurmagomed Abakarov from the village of Tando, according to a post on the municipality's official Telegram channel. According to the information on the plaques, both soldiers were killed in 2026 and posthumously awarded the Order of Courage. Gasulbeg Sharamazanov was born in 1969, and Nurmagomed Abakarov in 2002. Thus, at least 1,934 soldiers from Dagestan have been officially recognized as killed in Ukraine. The "Caucasian Knot" maintains a list of names of natives of the North Caucasus and Southern Federal Districts killed in the military operation. The list was compiled based on data officially released by government officials and law enforcement agencies, according to the "Caucasian Knot" report "NVO Statistics: Losses Are Growing for Southern Russia." At the end of April, the Botlikh District administrat

60. Russia's Medvedev to clash with World No. 1 Sinner in 2026 Italian Open semifinals

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TASS

■ **URL:** <https://tass.com/sports/2131105>

■ Summary:

In the quarterfinals, the player defeated Martin Landaluce from Spain ROME, May 15. /TASS/. Russian tennis star Daniil Medvedev advanced to the semifinals of the 2026 ATP Italian Open tennis tournament in Rome after beating Martin Landaluce from Spain. In a match that lasted for two hours and 23 minutes, the 7th-seeded Medvedev, who is playing under a neutral status at the tournament, outplayed his Spanish opponent 1-6; 6-4; 7-5. In the semifinals the Russian is set to face off against top-seed Jannik Sinner of Italy, who earlier breezed past another Russian tennis star, Andrey Rublev, in straight sets 6-2; 6-4. Medvedev, 30, spent sixteen weeks as the world's number one player in 2022. Currently, he's the 9th-ranked player in the world. He previously won the 2021 US Open and is now a 23-time ATP champion. He won five of those 22 titles in 2023. Also, in 2021, he won the Davis Cup as well as the ATP Cup playing for the Russian national team. The 2026 Italian Open tennis tournament is an ATP 1000 event. Played on outdoor clay courts, the 83rd edition of the tourney takes place at Rome's Foro Italico sports complex on May 5-17 and offers some \$9.6 million in prize money. The tournament's reigning champion is Carlos Alcaraz from Spain, who earlier withdrew from the current tournament citing an injury. On February 28, 2022, the International Olympic Committee (IOC) issued recommendations to international sports federations to bar athletes from Russia and Belarus from taking part
